nanoloop 2 · cheatsheet

unofficial summary of the official 2.8 manual · GBA cart & Analogue Pocket built-in version

Notation: [B]+▲ = hold [B], tap D-pad up. All sound parameters are set *per step* – there are no instruments. Channel is shown top-left, edit parameter top-right.

THE SEQUENCER

16 steps in a 4×4 grid; the playing step is darker.

▲▼◀▶ move cursor
[B] place note
[A] cut note / paste on empty step
[B]+▲▼◀▶ edit note (current parameter)
[A]+▲▼◀▶ edit extra parameters
[START] mono / chord mode (pitch param)
[R]+◀/▶ meta step
[SELECT] menu 1

Default parameter is pitch: [B]+▲▼ semitone, [B]+◀▶ octave.

***Meta step:** [R]+◀/▶/▼ makes a step play only every 2nd or 4th pattern round.*

MENU 1 – channel & parameter

◀▶ select edit parameter
▲▼ select channel
[B] back to sequencer
[B]/[A]+▲▼◀▶, [START] edit *all* notes at once
[A]+[START] mute / unmute channel
[R]+[START] note value / bar view
[R]+[SELECT] new / legacy mode (n / L, saved)
[R]+▲▼◀▶ randomise (repeat = wider range)
[SELECT] menu 2

Legacy mode = pre-2.8 menu editing ([A]+D-pad only).

CHANNELS

[R] mono PWM/FM, arp chords, pitch env/LFO
[L] mono PWM/FM, same as R
[S] poly PWM/FM: real chords, stereo phasing, filter/mod env
[N] noise: filter + speed, arp on speed

R/L/S: filtered pulse wave (variable width) or FM (mod amount + mod freq).

***Startup:** at the logo, pick colours – [START] pink/white, [SELECT] pink/black, ▲ grey/white.*

PARAM 1 – VOLUME / ENVELOPE

[B]+▲▼ volume
[B]+◀▶ length
[A]+▲▼ envelope mode: D / AD / gate
[A]+◀▶ click (R) / soft attack (L,S,N)

D = decay only. AD = attack = decay. Gate = full level for the set length. Far right = infinite envelope.

PARAM 2 – PITCH / CHORD

[B]+▲▼ semitone
[B]+◀▶ octave
[START] chord mode on/off
[B]+[START] chord: relative (note + intervals) / absolute (4 notes)
[A]+▲▼ chord interval
[A]+◀▶ select chord step (top note = pause)
[L] arpeggio envelope on/off

Chords: arpeggio on R/L, polyphonic on S. N has no pitch – always arpeggio (on playback freq).

PARAM 3 – BEND / LFO

[B]+▲▼ amplitude
[B]+◀▶ length / frequency
[A]+▲▼ envelope / LFO
[A]+◀▶ S only: pitch / filter LFO

Acts on pitch (R,L,S) and filter cutoff / FM mod depth (S,N). Lower half = retriggered, upper = free-running.

PARAM 4 – WAVEFORM

[B]+▲▼ cutoff / FM modulation
[B]+◀▶ pulse width / mod freq / noise speed
[A]+▲ FM (R,L,S) / GB noise (N)
[A]+▼ PWM / highpass noise (N)
[A]+▶ bandpass / metallic noise
[A]+◀ highpass / white noise

On N: [L] toggles GB noise 16/8-bit.

PARAM 5 – PAN / DELAY

[B]+◀▶ panning (S and N only)
[B]+▲▼ delay / delay + original

Editing delay for all notes from menu 1 hits only even steps – that is the swing control.

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patterns, files, songs & sync

Menu 2 (SELECT in menu 1) links to file menu, song editor, pattern tools and tempo/sync. SELECT steps back one menu level.

Unofficial cheatsheet, condensed from the official nanoloop 2.8 manual (nanoloop.com/two/nanoloop28.html). nanoloop is by Oliver Wittchow – this sheet is a summary, not affiliated.

MENU 2 – pattern tools & tempo

File menu: B **Song editor:** B or A (see song box)

Ping-pong: B + ◀ on · START random · B + ▶ normal

Pattern length: B + ▲▼ length

Shift: B + ◀▶ shift · A + ◀▶ shift, keep delay

Copy/paste: START copy pattern · A + B paste

Tempo: B + ◀▶ tempo · B + ▲▼ 1/x tempo for this channel

Transport: START start/master · A + B stop/slave · A pause (again: step manually) · B resume

Sync mode: A + ▲▼ (see sync box)

SONG EDITOR

B + ▲▼ select pattern

B + ◀▶ copy value to next step

A + ▲ load patterns at cursor

A + ◀▶ turn page (15 pages)

R channel follows tempo

L channel follows pattern length

START start song at cursor

SELECT back to menu 2

Start modes (from menu 2): B = pattern-sync, song follows the running loop. A = manual/external sync: START starts at once and sends sync, B + A = slave.

Song is saved when you leave *the editor – not if you power off inside it. Tempo is stored with each pattern.*

SYNC

S8 click every 2nd step (default; PO, Volca. . .)

S16 1 click per step

S24 3 clicks/step – for MIDI adaptor

SY1 clicks on left audio ch. (PO slave; not on GBA)

MIDI clock goes out via the link port (Pocket-to-MIDI cable).

CV sync: *in slave mode press B + SELECT – "c" under the tempo; 1 pulse per step.*

S16 auto-revert: *no clock for ~2 s → back to step 1.*

FILE MENU – save / load patterns

128 banks × 15 slots per channel. Slot 0 is read-only (loads an empty pattern). The bank also carries the waveforms – switching banks can change the sound at once.

▲▼ select channel · ◀▶ select slot · START bank menu · SELECT back to menu 1

B + ▼	save pattern to slot	B + ▲	load pattern from slot
A + ▼	save all 4 (column)	A + ▲	load column
B + ◀▶	next slot + load	A + ◀▶	next column + load all
B + R + ▲	load pattern with tempo	A + B + ▲	load column on 1st step
A + B + ▼	delete slot	A + B + ◀▶	mute / unmute / solo

Lock: *L + R locks saving ("X" bottom-left) against accidental overwriting.*

BANK MENU & TRANSFER

◀▶ move between: bank select | bank name | data transfer

Select bank: B + ▲▼◀▶ choose · A + B + ▲ copy bank · A + B + ▼ paste bank

Bank name: B + ▲▼ edit letter

Transfer: B + A + ▲ send bank · B + ▲▼ receive bank

Link transfer: connect both units (not a GBA multiplayer cable). Receiver presses A + B + ▼, sender A + B + ▲. On error, differing checksums are shown: SELECT cancels, A + B keeps the received data.